Regulation I/1 Application
Flag
State
Part 1 Common
areas, paragraph 6.1
Part 2 Flag States,
paragraphs 15.1, 16.1
and 22.1 to .2
National standards developed for
the implementation of SOLAS 1974
may be useful for these items
Regulation I/2 Definitions
Regulation I/3 Exemptions
Regulation I/4 Equivalents
Regulation I/5
Repairs,
alterations and
modifications

3.2 Surveys and certificates (regulations I/6 to 17)

3.2.1 Application: Unless expressly provided otherwise, the provisions of chapter I apply to new vessels.

Notes:

1. Administrations may entrust the inspections and surveys either to surveyors nominated for the purpose or to organizations recognized by it (regulation I/6(1)).

SOURCE: MSC.571(109).pdf
URL:
https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.571(109).pdf
purpose or to organizations recognized by it (regulation I/6(1)).

2. Administrations may exempt vessels from the annual surveys if it considers the application is unreasonable and impracticable and expand the "time window" of the periodical and intermediate surveys (regulation I/1(6), 7(1)(c), 8(1)(c) and 9(1)(c)).

CHAPTER I SURVEYS AND CERTIFICATES SUMMARY

3.2.2 Chapter I also deals with survey and certification requirements. It makes provisions for:

.1 inspections and surveys and the nomination of surveyors or recognized organizations by the Administration (regulation 6);

.2 surveys on the life -saving appliances and other emergency equipment (regulation 7);

.3 survey on the radio installations (regulation 8);

.4 survey on the structure, machinery and other equipment (regulation 9);

.5 maintenance of the condition of the vessel and its equipment after survey (regulation 10); and

---

SOURCE: MSC.571(109).pdf
URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.571(109).pdf

.5 maintenance of the condition of the vessel and its equipment after survey (regulation 10); and

.6 issuance of certificates, duration, forms of certificates and their acceptance, as well as certification and accompanying privileges (regulations 11 to 17).

MSC RESOLUTION MSC.571(109) (adopted on 6 December 2024)
INTERIM GUIDANCE TO ASSIST IN THE IMPLEMENTATION OF THE CAPE TOWN AGREEMENT OF 2012

SOURCE: MSC.581(110).pdf
URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.581(110).pdf

RESOLUTION MSC.581(110) (adopted on 27 June 2025)
REVISED RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ENTERING ENCLOSED SPACES ABOARD SHIPS
MSC 110/21/Add.3
Annex 28, page 1
I:\MSC\110\MSC 110-21-Add.3.docx

ANNEX 28

RESOLUTION MSC.581(110)
(adopted on 27 June 2025)
REVISED RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ENTERING ENCLOSED SPACES ABOARD SHIPS

THE MARITIME SAFETY COMMITTEE,

RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Committee

RECALLING ALSO its adoption, by resolution A.864(20), of the Recommendations for entering enclosed spaces aboard ships , and by resolution A.1050(27), of the Revised recommendations for entering enclosed spaces aboard ships , incorporating therein recommendations for entering cargo spaces, tanks, pump-rooms, fuel tanks, cofferdams, duct keels, ballast tanks and similar enclosed spaces,

RECALLING FURTHER that SOLAS regulation III/19.3.6 requires enclosed space entry and

---

SOURCE: MSC.581(110).pdf
URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.581(110).pdf

keels, ballast tanks and similar enclosed spaces,
RECALLING FURTHER that SOLAS regulation III/19.3.6 requires enclosed space entry and rescue drills, SOLAS regulation XI-1/7 requires the carrying of atmosphere testing instrument for enclosed spaces, and SOLAS chapter IX and the ISM Code require management for the safe operation of ships,

RECALLING that the Maritime Safety Committee is requested to keep the revised recommendations under review and amend them as necessary,

BEING CONCERNED about the continued loss of life resulting from personnel entering shipboard spaces in which the atmosphere is unable to support life, owing to oxygen depletion, oxygen enrichment, toxicity or flammability,
BEING AWARE of the work undertaken in this regard by the International Labour Organization, Governments and segments of the private sector,
RECOGNIZING that organizational leadership plays a crucial role in successful
---
SOURCE: MSC.581(110).pdf
URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.581(110).pdf
Governments and segments of the private sector,
RECOGNIZING that organizational leadership plays a crucial role in successful
implementation of this guidance by empowering shipboard staff to make the right decisions,
HAVING CONSIDERED , at its 110th session, the recommendation made by the Sub-Committee on Carriage of Cargoes and Containers at its tenth session,
1 ADOPTS the Revised recommendations for entering enclosed spaces aboard ships, as set out in the annex to the present resolution;
2 INVITES Governments to bring the annexed Revised Recommendations to the attention of shipowners, ship operators, seafarers, port and terminal operators and port workers, urging them to apply them, as appropriate, to all ships and operations;
3 INVITES the Assembly to revoke resolution A.1050(27) and to endorse the action taken by the Maritime Safety Committee.
RESOLUTION MSC.581(110) (adopted on 27 June 2025)
REVISED RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ENTERING ENCLOSED SPACES ABOARD SHIPS

SOURCE: MSC.581(110).pdf
URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.581(110).pdf
RESOLUTION MSC.581(110) (adopted on 27 June 2025)
REVISED RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ENTERING ENCLOSED SPACES ABOARD SHIPS

ANNEX
REVISED RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ENTERING ENCLOSED SPACES ABOARD SHIPS
Preamble
The objective of these recommendations is to encourage the adoption of safety procedures and the development of sound practices aimed at preventing casualties to, and enhancing the safety of, personnel entering or working in enclosed spaces where there may be an oxygen-deficient, oxygen-enriched, flammable and/or toxic atmosphere. Additionally, in the event of an emergency within an enclosed space, these recommendations provide guidance for an appropriate, planned and considered response complying with ship-specific enclosed space rescue plans.
Investigations into the circumstances of enclosed space accidents have shown that a failure to
---
SOURCE: MSC.581(110).pdf
URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.581(110).pdf
Investigations into the circumstances of enclosed space accidents have shown that a failure to

systematically identify the hazards, assess the risks and implement an appropriate entry procedure remains a significant factor in many accidents. Likewise, the complex structure of some spaces on board ships creates problems with appropriate ventilation, illumination and movement within the space. Organizational leadership on ship and shore plays a crucial role in successful implementation of this guidance by empowering shipboard staff to make the right decisions.
These recommendations apply to all types of ships and provide guidance to ship operators, seafarers and shore personnel to work on board ships. It should be noted that on ships where entry into enclosed spaces may be infrequent, for example, on certain pas senger ships or small general cargo ships, the dangers may be less apparent, and accordingly there may be a need for increased vigilance.

SOURCE: MSC.581(110).pdf
URL:
https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.581(110).pdf
small general cargo ships, the dangers may be less apparent, and accordingly there may be a need for increased vigilance.
These recommendations are intended to complement national laws or regulations, accepted standards or particular procedures which may exist for specific trades, ships or types of shipping operations.
It may not be practicable to apply all of these recommendations to all situations; however, when applying these recommendations becomes impracticable, every endeavour should be made to observe the intent of the recommendations, and attention should be paid to the hazards that may be involved in the specific entry and mitigations required to reduce the risks to an acceptable level.
1 INTRODUCTION
The atmosphere in any enclosed space may be oxygen -deficient or oxygen-enriched and/or contain flammable and/or toxic gases or vapours. Such unsafe atmospheres could also subsequently occur in a space previously found to be safe. Unsafe atmospheres are lik ely to
---
SOURCE: MSC.581(110).pdf
URL:
https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.581(110).pdf
subsequently occur in a space previously found to be safe. Unsafe atmospheres are lik ely to be present in spaces that are connected to a space containing a hazardous atmosphere and may also be present in spaces adjacent to those spaces where a hazard is known or suspected to be present.
1.1 An unsafe atmosphere can also quickly occur in a space previously found to be safe, including cargo holds and tanks where the hatch covers and tank covers have been open for some time. Unsafe atmospheres can occur in frequently visited working areas and stores, such